

Charles Edward Ives was born on October 20, 1874, in Danbury, Connecticut. His father was from a prosperous local family and had served as the youngest bandmaster in the Union Army during the Civil War. Young Charlie studied piano and organ and absorbed Danbury's rich musical life, from classical concerts to rousing congregational hymn-singing. He joined his father's brass band as a drummer and, at the age of 14, became a church organist.



GEORGE IVES

Charles Ives's father, seen here c. 1865, was the leader of a brass band in Danbury and played numerous instruments.